Some 5 km north-west of Vaishali's relic stupa, a pillar and possibly a stupa too were also built by Ashoka. A magnificent monolith with a stone lion still standing on the capital, the Vaishali specimen is not merely the heaviest of all Ashoka's pillars but also one of the most impressive.[48] Though uninscribed (unclear why), its other characteristics show it as indisputably Ashokan. The stupa in its vicinity is contemporary with the pillar. It yielded the fragment of a stone umbrella and pieces of a relic casket, all bearing the polish typical of monuments and artefacts associated with the emperor.[49] Not all stupas attributed to Ashoka can be so easily identified. The original fabric of the Dharmarajika stupa in Taxila, for instance, has not survived, and the only tangible indication is the name Dharmaraja, linked with Ashoka as he who built dharmarajikas, i.e. stupas over relics of the Buddha. The presence of two small mullers of sandstone, of the kind used in Ashokan pillars, is considered as the clinching evidence for the excavator.[50]

Xuanzang, when describing the many structures associated with the Buddha, noted that the Vaishali stupa built by 'Ashoka-raja' had on its side a high stone pillar with a lion on top.

Oddly, Ashoka's presence in Pataliputra is much less in evidence. This is perhaps because much of ancient Pataliputra is buried under Patna and most excavations have been in the outskirts. No inscribed Ashokan pillar or stupa ruin has appeared, the only major architectural relic that may have had something to do with Ashoka being a pillared hall at the Kumrahar locality of Patna.[51] Traces of eighty monolithic pillar bases and fragments of pillars bearing Mauryan polish were found here. Access was through a pillared porch approached by steps constructed on wooden platforms. The platforms themselves stood in the waters of a canal which brought visitors to the hall by boat. The pillared hall was possibly open on all sides (since no screen walls of any kind were found) and huge quantities of wood were possibly used in making the ceiling, a thick layer of ash at the site suggesting this.